- The computer acceptscharacters as symbols not as language.

- It is not portable, i.e. if the document is sent to another computer, if the same font is not available, it is recognized as symbols not as original characters.

To overcome the drawbacks in the first method, the interface method provides the following advantages:

- It follows Unicode technique. Hence knowledge of Tamil typing is not necessary.
- It is easy to type documents in Tamil in any word processor.
- Some of the Unicode fonts like "Arial Unicode" supports all Indian languages including Tamil and English using respective language interface.

6.3.1 Download and Install Tamil Typing Interface

Many Tamil Typing Interfaces are available as open source such as "Murasu"(it is exclusively for Tamil), "NHM Writer"(It is universal to all Indian languages) etc.

To download and install:

- "Murasu" use the link : http://anjal.net/download
- "NHM writer" use the link : http://software.nhm.in

6.3.2 Connecting with Writer

Once the Tamil Interface is downloaded and installed in your computer, each time you start, the interface automatically gets activated and this is indicated by a unique symbol in the notification area. By default the shortcut keys are set as Alt+1 for English and Alt+2 for Tamil and it can be changed. For different languages shortcut keys can be assigned.

6.3.3 Entering Text in Tamil

Step 1 : Open a new document in Writer.

Step 2 : Press Alt+2 to type in Tamil, Alt + 1 to type in English.

The keyboard structure for Tamil interface is given in Annexure-2:

Different styles of Unicode Tamil fonts can be downloaded from this link:http://www.tamilvu.org/tkbd/indexen.html

6.4. Editing a document

Once a document is typed, it can be edited in many ways. If there is some insertions or deletions, it can be done while typing or after typing also. Corrections can be made in two different ways :

Backspace Key: Deletes the character to the left of the insertion pointer

Delete Key : Deletes the character to the right of the insertion pointer

To insert new text in between, if something is left out, insertion can be made by taking the insertion pointer to the current location and Press the Insert Key, the newly typed text is inserted, and the existing text moves to the right.This is **Insert mode.** Press the **Insert Key** again,